

Internship Experience – Appian

Company: Appian

Role: User Experience Design Intern

Stipend: ₹1,50,000

Round 0 – Application Based

The first stage was an application screening. From my observation, over two-thirds of applicants advanced to the next round.

Round 1 – Glider AI (Essay + MCQ)

This round consisted of 9 questions: 6 essay/text type and 3 MCQs.

Essay questions included:

- Explaining UI and UX Design to a non-technical person.
- Describing how I would approach adding a new feature.
- Listing the tools I use for design.
- Naming my favorite app and explaining why.

MCQs included:

- User testing frameworks like A/B testing.
- General design-related concepts.

Out of 157 candidates, 17 were shortlisted for the in-person interviews.

Round 2 – Technical + Mild HR Questions

The interviewer started by asking how I felt. I said “mixed feelings” since it was my first interview. He briefly shifted the conversation to my hobbies, likely to ease my nerves and make me feel comfortable before diving into technical questions. I mentioned movies, talked a bit on it.

I then introduced myself, highlighting real-world projects such as my AI EdTech platform **Vision Solve AI**, which people actively use. He asked me to open the website on his laptop and gave feedback on the landing page:

- Keep the primary CTA on the right rather than the left.
- Learn more about color contrast for accessibility.

Next, he asked me to design a gender selection form. I sketched two options:

1. A standard design.
2. An icon-based toggle design.

His advice: Stick to **universal UI patterns** rather than experimental ones to avoid confusing users, as UI has matured to a point where novelty often hinders usability.

We then discussed career scenarios:

- Would I leave if I got a better offer?
- Would I switch from design to development within the company?

Tip: If you're sure you want the role, stick to it. If you know you'll switch, be honest — but only if you're certain.

Before ending the round, I asked: *“How will Appian compete with other no-code tools?”* — a tip I got from seniors: always ask thoughtful questions.

Observation: If you're called for the next round immediately, you're likely selected. Long waits usually mean lower ranking.

Round 3 – HR Round

The HR interviewer repeated job-switch and domain-switch scenarios.

Domain switch answer:

I'm willing to code frontend for designs I create. If it's someone else's design, I can still code it, but it won't give me the same satisfaction. If no design role is available, I'd take a frontend role because I wouldn't want to miss working at Appian.

AI role job-switch answer:

I'd switch if I stopped getting challenging tasks or learning opportunities at Appian.

He was impressed with both answers.

When asked if I had questions, I asked what he liked most about Appian. The round was short but reinforced the importance of confidence, friendliness, and enthusiasm.

Round 4 – Interview with Regional Company Head

We discussed my schooling, hometown, and Vision Solve AI's AI video generation idea. He felt I might be more of a coder than a designer and gave this advice:

UXD is not for everyone. Without passion, you'll regret it. If you plan to switch to SWE later, you'll fall behind those who started as SWE. This is just an internship; you still have time to decide your career path.

This felt cinematic — like a pre-rejection speech.

For my question, I asked if work-life balance was what he liked most about Appian. He reacted strongly, saying work-life balance is a buzzword and questioned why I would expect it early in my career. He refused to answer that and suggested asking more meaningful questions.

I followed up with: *“So what do you like the most about Appian?”* His response:

Appian loves tech people, and tech people love Appian.

Result

Out of 17 shortlisted candidates, 2 received offers — I was one of them.

Conclusion

Appian focuses on **passion**, **knowledge**, and **projects**. Especially for UXD, your portfolio speaks volumes. For any role, be genuine and assess your passion for the position before applying. If you don't have any deployed projects, be ready to answer a lot of Figma questions.

Contact for any doubts:

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